



KNOW HOW



❶ I am using Mandriva 2009 on my laptop. How can I check my runlevel and also the services that are running on my system?

—*Shiv Prasad, by e-mail*

A. Use command `runlevel` or `who -r` to check which your current runlevel is. You can use the `chkconfig` command to check which processes are scheduled to run on which run level. Please read man pages for these commands to know more.

❷ I am a student and a regular reader of LINUX For You. I have a computer in my room which is shared by my room mates. They often change the root password of my computer. I know that by applying password to my GRUB I can restrict them from doing so. Can you please let me know how I can set a password for GRUB, which I have not done during my OS installation. I am using Fedora. Do I need to reinstall it?

—*Jophie Thomas, Mangalore*

A. Not at all! You do not need to reinstall OS just to apply a password to GRUB. Here are the steps that will help you out. Open terminal and log in as root. Now type `grub` at the root prompt. Use the `md5crypt` command to encrypt password as follows:

```
grub> md5crypt
Password: *****
Encrypted: $1$kdFq$ay6oq@CUMPa.wEK95.
J8S/
```

Copy this encrypted password and exit grub mode by typing *quit* at the `grub>` prompt.

Now open the `/etc/grub.conf` file in a text editor and add the following in the global section of the config file:

```
password --md5 $1$kdFq$ay6oq@CUMPa.
wEK95.J8S/
```

Save the edited file and restart your computer. Try entering single user mode and see the Grub prompt you for a password now.

❸ I am a subscriber of LFY since its inception, and enjoy the content and distribution packages provided. I am trying to install the Tata Indicom USB stick modem on my P-III processor desktop with Mandriva 2007.

However, during a modem query in KPPP, it first gives a message that modem is detected, and then as the status bar shows progress, a message window appears with a message “Query timed out”, and the process terminates.

Can you please let me know how this can be installed? Also, this distribution does not have the `wvdial` package and a guideline is required as to how this can be obtained.

—*A.K.Das, Jamshedpur*

You can try to install `wvdial` from the Mandriva DVD. In case you don't have the DVD media handy, you can refer to easypurpmi.zarb.org/old and follow the steps to configure the online software repository. Once

you're done, execute the following command as root:

```
urpmi wvdial
```

After installing it you can configure the `/etc/wvdial.conf` file as given below, but first, remember to check your `dmesg` to confirm your modem settings. In case your computer does not recognise your device as modem, then check the `dmesg` for the 'Product ID' and 'Vendor ID' of the card. Once you know these IDs, `modprobe` for the driver by running the following command as root:

```
modprobe usbserial vendor=0x<vendor id
here> product=0x<product id here>
```

Now run the following command to create `/etc/wvdial.conf`:

```
wvdialconf /etc/wvdial.conf
```

Open the `/etc/wvdial.conf` file in a text editor and add the following to it:

```
[Modem0]
Modem = /dev/ttyUSB0
Baud = 115200
SetVolume = 0
Dial Command = ATDT
Init1 = ATZ
FlowControl = Hardware (CRTSCTS)
[Dialoger tata]
Username = <your username>
Password = <your password>
Phone = #777
Stupid Mode = 1
Inherits = Modem0
```

Now run `wvdial` as follows:

```
wvdial tata
```

Hope this helps and you are able to connect to the Internet. **END**